Revision Date:
May 1, 2021

Background:
The primary focus of Employment Services (ES) is to help participants set and achieve career goals and build skills necessary to obtain and retain employment. ES participants must be assigned to activities leading to self-sufficiency through employment, education or training. Employment Case Managers (ECMs) utilize the Assessment (ASMT) as the primary tool for developing the first ES plan to assign the most appropriate activities and supportive services.

Purpose:
The purpose of this revision is to provide information per Senate Bill (SB) 1232 on new regulations regarding participants who are enrolled in **publicly** funded postsecondary education.

Policy:
ASMT is the evaluation of various factors related to a participant's employability, such as personal and family needs, work and education history, career goals, areas of strength, skills, and needs for supportive services to remove barriers to employment and participation.

The ECM is required to complete an ASMT when the participant is ready to sign the first ES plan after:
- Successfully completing Initial Job Search
- Being excluded from Initial Job Search or other Initial Engagement activities for a valid reason
- Being assigned to Mental Health/Substance Abuse/Family Violence Services in excess of four consecutive weeks, which requires the development of a plan

Note: An ASMT is not required to assign activities and supportive services specified in a Family Reunification Plan (CPG 40.183.D).

ES Participants Enrolled in **Publicly** Funded Postsecondary Education
ES participants enrolled in **publicly** funded postsecondary education will complete an ASMT or Reassessment (ASMT2) only for the purpose of assigning appropriate activities to address identified barriers. If ASMT/ASMT2 is completed, the outcome cannot be used to limit or restrict a participant's choice in educational or training goals.

ES participants cannot be prevented from attending school due to a barrier or placed in Noncompliance for refusal to complete ASMT/ASMT2. The ECM will document the reason for refusal to complete ASMT/ASMT2 in case comments.

Note: Students not enrolled in **publicly** funded postsecondary education are still required to complete an ASMT/ASMT2, as applicable, to develop a plan to assign appropriate activities and necessary supportive services.

Assessment
The ASMT evaluation process includes the following:
- Evaluating the participant's performance in Initial Job Search and outcome

- Reviewing information gathered during Appraisal and participation in Family Stabilization (FS) or other Initial Engagement activities such as Behavioral Health Services (BHS) and or Initial Job Search
- Identifying the participant's job skills, career, and self-sufficiency goals in relation to local market conditions, educational and training needs, and remaining CalWORKs (CW) and Welfare to Work (WTW) 24-Month Time Clock months
- Evaluating potential referral to Work Experience (WEX) or similar training/work programs based on the participant's work history and job readiness
- Completing a comprehensive discussion regarding educational/training opportunities to meet CW federal or minimum standards during the WTW 24-Month Time Clock (WTW 24-MTC) or CW federal standards after the WTW 24-MTC is exhausted
- Developing the first ES plan to assign appropriate activities and necessary supportive services to help the participant to achieve career and self-sufficiency goals and address barriers to participation and employment
- Working with the participant to create a road map with necessary steps to achieve long and short-term goals set as the result of the ASMT
- Evaluating potential referral to barrier removal activities and programs (e.g. BHS, FS, Housing Support Program (HSP))

Reassessment
ASMT2is the evaluation method used by the ECM to develop subsequent ES plans and includes all pertinent elements discussed during ASMT. The ECM will conduct a ASMT2 in the following circumstances:

When the Participant…	Then the ECM Will …
• Completes assigned activities/plan • Requests to participate in additional activities • Does not complete assigned activities for any reason • Does not maintain satisfactory progress in assigned activities	• Identify the reason why the participant is not able to complete assigned activities or is not making satisfactory progress • Develop a new plan based upon the ASMT2 outcome
May benefit from additional education or training to acquire marketable job skills and address barriers to employment and participation	Develop a new plan by assigning additional activities to assist the individual in becoming employed and overcoming barriers
Is transferred to another ES site and the newly assigned ECM determines that a ASMT2 is needed due to a change in Registration Status, ES activities, and/or participation hours	Develop a new plan based upon the ASMT2 outcome

If the ES participant disagrees with the outcome of the ASMT or ASMT2, the matter must be referred to a Third-Party Assessor who will complete an independent evaluation of the participant's circumstances, needs and ES plan in question. ES staff and the participant are required to comply with the Third-Party Assessor's findings and recommendations.

Modified Assessment/Reassessments
A Modified ASMT/ASMT2 may be conducted through a telephone call any time an office visit creates an unnecessary burden on the participant due to work/class scheduling conflicts, excessive travelling time or any other valid reasons. Elements evaluated during a Modified ASMT/ASMT2 or an ASMT/ASMT2 completed in person at an ES site are the same.

Procedures:
CalWORKs Processing Guides 10-005.F.1, 10-300.A.1 and 10-300.D.1

References:
Eligibility Assistance Standards (EAS) 42.711.55; ACL 21-04

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by May 31, 2024.

Approval for Release:

5-10-21

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